

Ὀππιανὸς ὁ Ἀναζαρβηνός

## Fishing in the Epic of Oppian of Anazarbus

eul\_aid: qta

**Period:** Ῥωμαϊκὴ [Roman](#)  
**Dialect:** Ἑπικὴ [Epic \(Homeric\)](#)  
**Domain:** Ἔπος [Epic](#)  
**Format:** Ἑμμετρος Verse

Oppian of Anazarbus was a Greek didactic epic poet of the 2nd century CE, a native of Anazarbus in Cilicia. Details of his life derive from a legendary biography and his own work. Tradition holds he presented his poem to the emperors Marcus Aurelius and Commodus in Rome, a story used to date his activity.

He is often conflated with a later poet, Oppian of Corycus, author of the *Cynegetica*, a confusion recorded in the *Suda*. His sole surviving work is the *Halieutica*, a five-book didactic epic in Homeric hexameters on marine life and fishing methods.

Oppian's significance rests on his contribution to imperial Greek didactic poetry. The *Halieutica* is a valuable source for ancient marine biology and fishing lore, blending mythology with natural observation. His work exemplifies the sophisticated Greek literary culture sustained under the Roman Empire.

### Works (1)

- [Ἀλιευτικά · Fishing](#) · 3517 passages